

Irrational Numbers

An Irrational number is a number that cannot be written as a ratio of two integers.

Rational number - the decimal either terminates (ends), or recurs (repeats).

The test:
Does the decimal terminate or recur?

Irrational number - the decimal doesn't terminate (end) or recur (repeat).

Exercise 6.6

Are the following numbers rational or irrational?

$$\frac{5}{7} = 0.71428571428571428571428571428571$$

The numbers 714285 recur (repeat) thus the number is a rational number.

$$\sqrt{3} = 1.7320508075688772935274463415059$$

There appears to be no recurring numbers, thus $\sqrt{3}$ is an irrational number.

- 1 Is $0.81818181818181818181818181818181 (= \frac{9}{11})$ a rational number or an irrational number?
- 2 Is $\sqrt{2}$ a rational number or an irrational number?
 $\sqrt{2} = 1.4142135623730950488016887242097$
- 3 Is π (pi) a rational number or an irrational number?
 $\pi = 3.1415926535897932384626433832795$
(π is the ratio of the circumference of a circle to the diameter of the circle.)
- 4 Is $\sqrt{4}$ a rational number or an irrational number?
 $\sqrt{4} = 2.0$
- 5 Is $0.61538461538461538461538461538462 (= \frac{8}{13})$ a rational number or an irrational number?
- 6 Is e (Euler's Number) a rational number or an irrational number?
 $e = 2.7182818284590452353602874713527$
- 7 Is ϕ (The Golden Ratio) a rational number or an irrational number?
 $\phi = 1.61803398874989484820$
- 8 Is $0.57894736842105263157894736842105263157894 (= \frac{11}{19})$ a rational number or an irrational number?